

SOC Investigation Report - Email Authentication SPF/DKIM Fail

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) have been defanged for safe handling. Replace hxxp/hxxps with http/https and [.] with . before operational use.

Client	Maple Tax Solutions (MTS)
Prepared by	Graham McKean
Date	August 2026
Classification	CONFIDENTIAL
Severity	Low

Findings

Alert	Email - Authentication SPF/DKIM Fail
Classification	True Positive - Successfully Prevented
Severity	Low
Detection Source	Azure Sentinel (Scheduled Alerts)
MITRE ATT&CK	Initial Access (T1566)
Sender	kubo[@]arutemisu[.]com
Recipient	info[@]mapletaxsolutions[.]ca
Sender IP	153[.]127[.]234[.]5
Subject	Action Required: Important Document
Delivery	Blocked and Quarantined
Threat Classification	Phish, Spam
Authentication	SPF Pass, DKIM None, DMARC BestGuessPass, CompAuth Pass

Investigation Summary

The investigation confirmed that a phishing email targeted a single recipient. Microsoft Defender for Office 365 identified the message as phishing and spam and automatically blocked it before it reached the recipient's mailbox, placing it into quarantine.

The investigation identified the sender, recipient, sender IP address, subject and embedded URLs. Although the Sentinel alert name referenced an SPF/DKIM authentication issue, SPF passed and DKIM was absent. The phishing verdict was instead supported by Microsoft fingerprint matching and malicious URL reputation detections rather than an SPF failure.

No evidence was found that the email was delivered, that the recipient interacted with it, or that additional recipients were targeted by the same sender or sender IP. No attachments were identified in the available Defender telemetry. Based on the evidence available, the incident was successfully contained with no evidence of compromise.

Timeline

Time	Event
30 Jul 2026 18:53:28 UTC	Defender extracted URLs from the email.
30 Jul 2026 18:53:30 UTC	Email processed and classified as Phish and Spam.
30 Jul 2026 18:53:30 UTC	Email blocked and placed into quarantine.
Investigation	Validated authentication, delivery status, message metadata available in telemetry, URLs, campaign scope and user impact.

5Ws and 1H

Who	Sender: kubo[.]arutemisu[.]com. Targeted recipient: info[.]mapletaxsolutions[.]ca.
What	A phishing email containing malicious/suspicious URLs was detected by Microsoft Defender and prevented before delivery.
When	30 Jul 2026 at 18:53:30 UTC during the scheduled Sentinel detection window.
Where	Detected in Microsoft Defender for Office 365 and surfaced through Microsoft Sentinel.
Why	The message was classified as Phish and Spam based on fingerprint matching and malicious URL reputation. SPF passed; DKIM was absent. Public OSINT also indicated moderate abuse associated with the sender IP.
How	A scheduled Sentinel analytic surfaced the event. Defender blocked and quarantined the email before user interaction.

Observed / Suspicious Indicators

- Sender: kubo[.]arutemisu[.]com
- Recipient: info[.]mapletaxsolutions[.]ca
- Sender IP: 153[.]127[.]234[.]5 - observed sender infrastructure; not labelled confirmed malicious based on public reputation alone
- Subject: Action Required: Important Document
- URL: hxxps://moirs1[.]es/ca/Updatemail[.]htm

- URL: [https://statement\[.\]pdf/](https://statement[.]pdf/)

Confirmed Malicious IOCs

- [https://moirs1\[.\]es/ca/Updatemail\[.\]htm](https://moirs1[.]es/ca/Updatemail[.]htm)
- [https://statement\[.\]pdf/](https://statement[.]pdf/)

External Threat Intelligence

Sender IP	153[.]127[.]234[.]5
Hosting Provider	KAGOYA JAPAN Inc.
Usage Type	Data Center / Web Hosting / Transit
ASN	AS24282
Location	Osaka, Japan
AbuseIPDB	143 reports with 38% confidence of abuse
VirusTotal	6 of 91 security vendors detected the IP as malicious

Assessment: Public OSINT supports increased suspicion of the sender infrastructure and corroborates, but does not replace, the Microsoft Defender evidence. These reputation results are not sufficient on their own to label the sender IP a confirmed malicious IOC.

Assessment

Alert Classification: True Positive - Successfully Prevented. The investigation confirmed a genuine phishing email that was blocked and quarantined before reaching the recipient. No evidence of successful delivery, user interaction, additional recipients or broader activity associated with the sender or sender IP was identified.

Recommendations

- Retain the quarantined email as evidence.
- Block the identified malicious URLs if not already enforced.
- Continue monitoring for future activity from the sender address or sender IP.
- Perform an Exchange message trace if additional mail-flow validation is required.
- Review the email body and full headers if available to capture additional campaign indicators and message identifiers.
- Continue phishing awareness training for end users.

Evidence Gaps / Limitations

No email body was reviewed and no Exchange message trace was performed. NetworkMessageId, InternetMessageId and any campaign/cluster identifier were not present in the evidence retained for this report, so the report does not claim that those identifiers were captured. External intelligence was limited

to public OSINT sources (AbuseIPDB and VirusTotal). Findings are based on Microsoft Defender XDR telemetry and supporting OSINT available during the investigation.